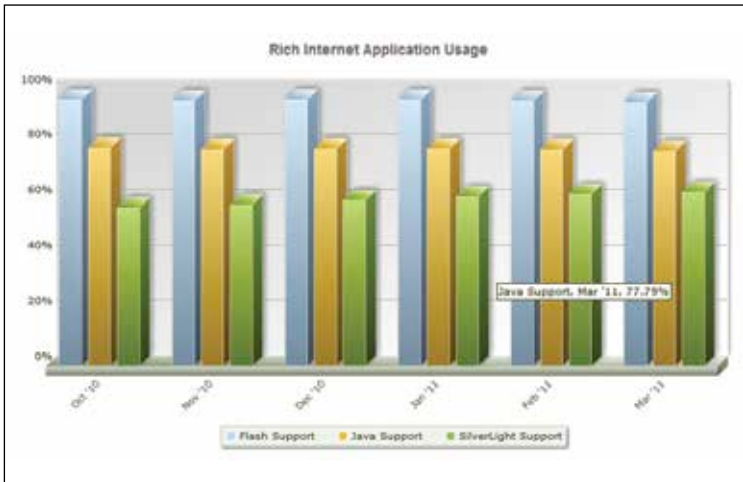




Usage stats for RIAs

However, some websites are already using, if not the complete spec but a subset of, HTML5. For example, YouTube and Vimeo have already rolled out use of the video element in HTML5. The working subset of HTML5 is nowhere close to the power of Flash. There are many advanced effects that are only available in Flash, Silverlight or Java. For example, Google, which is driving HTML5, relies on Flash in Google Maps for Street View and in Gmail for the multiple file upload capability. There are tens of thousands of Flash games on the web including game apps within Facebook. This wouldn't be possible with HTML5 anytime soon.

It's not just about features, but also about deployed infrastructure that favour Flash. A pragmatic perspective should look at the numerous tools, ad engines, business processes, infrastructure and platforms that support and/or enable Flash-based advertising. This aggregate mass will take a long time to shift to an alternative, no matter how good that alternative may be, due to sheer inertia of large scale systems that are operationally functional. HTML5 is the future of the web, for simple interactivity, including charting, some limited 3D vector graphics, image transforms, video and audio. It's possible that 90-95% of an average enterprise's needs could be met by HTML5. There are only a few classes of corporate apps that would gain significant benefit from Flash, Silverlight or Java over what's available in HTML5 or even in Ajax.